

PSY 250 Research Design & Analysis I

Summer 2026

Course number: PSY 250-402

Instructor: Skylar Yu, M.S.

Office hours: <https://calendly.com/skylaryu/appointment> Please book an appointment through this link. If none of the times work for you, please email me your availability.

Email: skylar.yu@colostate.edu

Undergraduate Teaching Assistants (UTAs)

Emma Thompson: Emma.Thompson@colostate.edu

Emma's office hours: <https://calendly.com/emmarthompson38/30min>

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Welcome

I am excited to welcome you to Research Design and Analysis I. Whether you are new to the subject or building from prior knowledge, this course will provide you with a comprehensive understanding of how research is designed, conducted, and analyzed.

Throughout the course, we will explore various research methods, discussing how, why, when, and what type of research and analysis are most appropriate in different scenarios. I encourage you to take full advantage of the interactive elements within the course, participate in discussions, engage with the multimedia content, and collaborate with your peers. While we may not meet face-to-face, I'm committed to creating a supportive and interactive online environment where you can thrive.

If you have any questions or need help with the course material, please don't hesitate to reach out via email or during my office hours. I'm here to support your learning journey and ensure you have the resources you need to succeed.

Course Description

This is an asynchronous online Course. However, please note that this course is set up with weekly lectures, assignments, and deadlines and is **not self-paced**. You will need to stay current because missed work cannot be made up.

Due Dates and Time

- The due date is the LAST day an assignment may be turned in, although you may always turn work in early.
- You can refer to the Course and Assignment Schedule spreadsheet for all assignment deadlines so that you can plan ahead.
- Please note that as the instructor, I may make changes during the semester to adjust assignments and deadlines. These changes will be announced on our Canvas page.

The concepts and assignments in this class can be challenging and demanding. Expect to dedicate time to it and do not fall behind with lectures and assignments. Successful students in this course do not procrastinate, do all the assignments, and are active in the learning process by asking questions.

Contact Policy

Please email me or the UTAs directly, and do NOT use the Canvas Inbox. It may take up to 48 business hours to respond to email. Please make sure you provide enough time to get a response. ("Business" means Monday through Friday 8 AM to 5:00 PM Mountain Time). Email received after 5:00 PM will be treated like it was sent the following business day. Email received over the weekend will be treated as if it was sent on Monday. Emails sent on the day an assignment is due likely will not receive a response until after the due date.

Please include "PSY250" in the subject line of your email.

Prerequisites for this Course:

PSY 100

Required Textbook:

The textbook in this class is designed with [Day One Access](#). We will be using:

- Morling B (2021). Research Methods in Psychology (5th edition). Norton; New York, NY.
- American Psychological Association. (2020). Publication Manual of the American Psychological Association (7th ed.). Washington, DC: American Psychological Association.

Required Course Materials

As this course has online proctoring for the two exams, **you will need access to a computer webcam.**

Watch [this brief video](#) to get a basic understanding of the LockDown Browser, Respondus, and the webcam feature.

Mental Health and Wellness

CSU is a community that cares. You are not alone. CSU Health Network Mental Health Services has trained professionals who can help. Your student fees provide access to a wide range of mental health and well-being support services.

Call Mental Health Services at (970) 491-6053, and they will work together with you to find out which services are right for you.

[CSU Health Network Mental Health Services](#)

Student mental health and well-being resources

If you are concerned about a friend or peer, use **Tell Someone** by calling (970) 491-1350 or visiting [Tell Someone](#) to share your concerns with a professional who can discreetly connect the distressed individual with the proper resources. Rams Take Care of Rams.

Career skills you can get from this course

- Project management
- Analytic skills
- Critical thinking
- Problem solving
- Communication skills

How to succeed in this course?

1. **Communicate early and often.** If you are having difficulty with the material, or if there is an out-of-class issue that is affecting your performance, the sooner I know about it, the sooner I can help. Also, as this is an asynchronous course, please make sure to leave the email notification on for Canvas Announcements and **check your CSU email regularly.**
2. **Be proactive and persevere.** Everyone enters this class with different levels of background knowledge and preparation. It is okay to find the material challenging, especially if it is new to you. This is an asynchronous course, that means if you need more time to understand the lectures, you can always go back and rewatch any parts at your own pace. Also, I am here to support you.
3. **Show respect and courtesy to everyone.** Be professional and respectful in your interactions with the instructor, UTAs, and your classmates.
4. **Use screens appropriately “in class.”** Using screen inappropriately during in-person class periods can hurt your learning process, and the same is true for online learning! It is more tempting to open other tabs (e.g., shopping, chatting, social media, etc.) while you are watching online lectures. If you are distracted, you may need to go back and rewatch part of the lecture or you won't remember what was said. You are already spending the time there, just stick with it with your full attention, which will make things easier. :)
5. **Reading, Lectures, and THEN Assignments.** There are readings assigned for most of the weeks and recorded lecture videos for each week's content that you are responsible for reading and watching BEFORE starting any of the assignments.
6. **Prioritize academic integrity.** Avoid any form of academic dishonesty, including plagiarism, cheating, and using generative AI or any unauthorized assistance to complete assignments, as it undermines your learning. You may use generative AI to assist your learning and help you to understand complicated concepts. However, **using generative AI, including but not limited to ChatGPT, Claude, and Gemini, to generate your assignments is prohibited.** Any suspected dishonest work will result in delayed grading until further assessment and discussion between the instructor and the student (see AI policy in a later section in this syllabus for more details).

Course Purpose

This course is a **gateway** to upper-division courses in Psychology. The purpose of this course is to prepare you for other courses in Psychology by:

- giving you experience with some of the steps involved in designing psychological research,
- describing a variety of methods used for collecting data in psychological research,
- helping you to understand the strengths and weaknesses of these different research methods; and,
- teaching you to write empirical papers in APA style.

Office Hours

You can always use my booking page to make an appointment with me or the UTAs.

What can we talk about during office hours?

- Introduce yourself
- Questions about course materials and assignments
- General questions about psychology, career goals, graduate school, etc.

What are some things you should think/work on your own first?

- Questions about course policy: please look for answers in the syllabus first. If you are sure that you cannot find the answer in the syllabus, feel free to talk to me.
- Definition questions: if the answer can be easily found by doing a Google search, you should search it first. If you feel that the answer you got from Google is not what you want, feel free to chat with me.

Course Requirements

"In-Class" Attendance Activities (15% - 75 pts)

Discussion Forum (10% - 50pts)

Small Assignments (15% - 75pts)

Research Proposal (40% - 200 pts)

Exams (20% - 100 pts)

Total points: 500

Your grade is based on the following:

1. "In-Class" Attendance Activities (15% - 75 pts)

- a. Lectures and reading are very important for an online asynchronous course. There will be a couple questions I want you to reflect on during the recorded lectures, just like those small group discussions in the in-person classrooms.
- b. You will only create one submission for each week's content, but the activities will be across multiple lecture videos. Not all lecture videos will have an attendance activity. **Please make sure you watch all the videos of that week, respond to all activities mentioned in the lectures that week, and then submit a SINGLE document** containing the responses to all those questions.

2. Discussion Forum (10% - 50pts)

- a. In these group discussions, you will have an opportunity to engage with your classmates by discussing the assigned topic and activities.
 - b. Your original post is worth 70% of the points, and your reply to a classmate is worth 30% of the points. The reply is due at the same time, so please avoid submitting your response at the last minute. They will be graded together under one assignment.
- 3. Small Assignments (15% - 75pts)**
 - a. There will be five small assignments that will help you to better understand some complicated concepts and topics. Completing them seriously will help you a lot with the exams!
- 4. Research Proposal (40% - 200 pts)**
 - a. You will design a study that is relevant to the springboard article you choose.
 - b. It looks like a big project, but I have dissected it into multiple digestible small steps. If you follow each step in time and read feedback, the final product is basically putting previous small assignments together.
 - c. This project contains the following parts (details about each step will be on Canvas):
 - i. Understanding the Research Proposal Assignment (5pts)
 - ii. Springboard Review Form (5pts)
 - iii. Literature Search Assignment (15pts)
 - iv. Your Research Ideas (8pts)
 - v. Hypothesis & Variable (12pts)
 - vi. Intro Outline (10pts)
 - vii. Peer review (15pts)
 - viii. Method Outline (10pts)
 - ix. Introduction (30pts)
 - x. Final Research Proposal (80pts)
 - xi. Final Presentation (10pts)
- 5. Exams (20% - 100 pts)**
 - a. There will be two exams: midterm and final. The final exam is accumulated but will weigh the materials taught after the midterm more.
 - b. Exams will be open for three days, and you must complete the exam in one sit (i.e., you CANNOT take a part of it, take a break, and then come back the second day).
 - c. Exams will be proctored. You must have a webcam to continue with the exam. You must adhere to academic integrity during the close book exams.

Late Assignments

All assignments will have a **20% deduction for each day** (24-hour period) that is late.

- Late for <24 hours, whatever grade you earned will be reduced by 20%.
- Late for 24-48 hours, whatever grade you earned will be reduced by 40%.
- Late for 48-72 hours, whatever grade you earned will be reduced by 60%.

- Late for 72-96 hours, whatever grade you earned will be reduced by 80%.
- Late for more than 96 hours, as long as it is submitted before Aug 1, 2026, you can still earn 10% of the grades.

You have **TWO 24-hour free passes**. By using a free pass for a specific assignment or quiz, it will extend the original deadline for 24 hours.

- For example, if you submit an assignment within one day after the due time and use one free pass, there will not be any late penalty.
- If you submit an assignment two days within the due time and use one free pass, there will be 20% deduction (= late for one day), rather than 40%.
- **Please leave a comment** on Canvas along with your submission to indicate that you want to use the free pass.
- You can only use one late pass at once.

No late submission nor free pass allowed for the midterm exam, final exam, final research proposal, or final presentations. You will NOT be able to submit these assignments after the due time.

Class Schedule

See the other file on the Syllabus page of your Canvas shell.

Letter Grade

Letter Grade	Total points	Percentage of final grade
A+	485+	97% or higher
A	450-484.99	90%-96.99%
B+	435-449.99	87%-89.99%
B	400-434.99	80%-86.99%
C+	385-399.99	77%-79.99%
C	350-384.99	70%-76.99%
D	300-349.99	60%-69.99%
F	Less than 300	59.99% or lower

There will NOT be any adjustment after the final grades have been determined, even if you are 0.01% away from the next letter grade. There will be many opportunities to earn extra credits throughout the summer session to boost your grade.

Academic Integrity

In this course, we are committed to upholding the principles of academic integrity. As your instructor, I have intentionally designed the course to promote learning in an equitable and honest environment. **Throughout this course, you will find abundant opportunities to accumulate points, and your final grade won't be determined by a single paper.** Together, we will explore diverse and interesting learning activities. As students in this course, you are

expected to engage actively with course materials, complete assignments independently (with opportunities for collaboration and discussion when appropriate), and refrain from any form of academic misconduct.

At the end of the course, you will be equipped with knowledge about how to conduct high quality research and read the scientific news with critical thinking, but only if YOU are the person who engage in learning.

As your instructor, if there is any academic misconduct, I will have to start a formal reporting procedure with the university.

The TILT website on academic integrity is also a good resource if you need more information on CSU guidelines: <http://tilt.colostate.edu/integrity/>.

AI Policy

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is *not permitted* for generating responses for course assignments.

There are several important reasons for this policy. First, copying AI-generated text into the work you submit for the course would amount to presenting others' words as your own, which is considered plagiarism. Second, AI engines can be unreliable on facts; anything they assert must be checked against reliable sources. Third, AI engines reproduce biases and prejudices from their source material—it is incumbent on us to check and correct for bias. Finally, employing AI eliminates the chance to use and demonstrate our own thinking on a topic. Indeed, the goal of this class is not to generate text artifacts with AI but to develop *your* ability to think critically about social psychology and research methods. As part of developing those skills, the work you submit should reflect *your own* thinking and writing, not products generated by AI.

Now you accidentally found a gem:

If you have reviewed the syllabus information so far, congratulations and thank you for reviewing all the material (I know it's a lot)! Email me (skylar.yu@colostate.edu) a picture of your favorite travel location by May 24th 11:59pm and you will be awarded 3 extra credit points. Please do not give away this opportunity to other students unless they have also read the syllabus.

Canvas Information and Technical Support

Canvas is where course content, grades, and communication will reside for this course.

Login: canvas.colostate.edu

Support: canvas.colostate.edu/support

For passwords or any other computer-related technical support, contact the [Central IT Technical Support Help Desk](#).

Voice: (970) 491-7276

Email: help@colostate.edu

For info on using browsers, apps, and third-party tools with Canvas see [Student Support Canvas](#).

Diversity and Inclusion

I am committed to fostering a diverse and inclusive learning environment in this course. Diversity enriches our learning experience by exposing us to different perspectives and promoting critical thinking skills. In this course, I actively encourage open dialogue, where every student's voice is valued and respected. I believe that inclusivity is fundamental to promoting academic and personal growth. To maintain this inclusive atmosphere, I employ various strategies, including encouraging open and respectful communication, facilitating diverse perspectives, and empowering student choice.

I am dedicated to helping *all* students learn, and I firmly believe that every student, regardless of their background, has the potential to excel and make meaningful contributions to this class.

Let us work together to create a supportive and welcoming environment where all students can enjoy the learning of psychology and reach their full potential. As psychology is so close to our everyday life, your unique experiences and perspectives are valuable and will enrich our collective learning journey.

Accommodations

CSU is committed to the principle of universal learning. This means that our classroom, our virtual spaces, our practices, and our interactions should be as inclusive as possible. Mutual respect, civility, and the ability to listen and observe others carefully are crucial to universal learning.

If you are a student who will need accommodation in this class, please contact your instructor to discuss your individual needs. Any accommodation must be discussed in a timely manner. A verifying memo from the [Student Disability Center \(SDC\)](#) is required before any accommodation is provided.

[The Student Disability Center \(SDC\)](#) has the authority to verify and confirm the eligibility of students with disabilities for the majority of accommodations. While some accommodations may be provided by other departments, a student is not automatically eligible for those accommodations unless their disability can be verified and the need for the accommodation confirmed, either through SDC or through acceptable means defined by the particular department. Faculty and staff may consult with the SDC staff whenever there is doubt as to the appropriateness of an accommodative request by a student with a disability.

The goal of SDC is to normalize disability as part of the culture of diversity at Colorado State University. The characteristic of having a disability simply provides the basis of the support that is available to students. The goal is to ensure students with disabilities have the opportunity to be as successful as they have the capability to be.

Support and services are offered to student with functional limitations due to visual, hearing, learning, or mobility disabilities as well as to students who have specific physical or mental health conditions due to epilepsy, diabetes, asthma, AIDS, psychiatric diagnoses, etc. Students who are temporarily disabled are also eligible for support and assistance.

Any student who is enrolled at CSU, and who self-identifies with SDC as having a disability, is eligible for support from SDC. Specific accommodation is determined individually for each student and must be supported by appropriate documentation and/or evaluation of needs consistent with a particular type of disability. SDC reserves the right to ask for any appropriate documentation of disability in order to determine a student's eligibility for accommodations as well as in support for specific accommodative requests. The accommodative process begins once a student meets with an accommodation specialist in the SDC.

If you have circumstances that merit accommodations through the SDC, please notify me as soon as possible (**preferably within the first two weeks of the summer term**). I am happy to work with you to help you succeed in the class. Although I try to monitor accommodations and implement them proactively, I do sometimes need reminders. If you have an accommodation that is not addressed, please let me know at once and I will remedy the situation as quickly as I can.

When Life Happens

If you experience emergency circumstances that adversely affect your performance in the course, such as a major illness, a family emergency, or a traumatic event, please reach out so that we can discuss ways to facilitate your success in the course. Within the bounds of fairness to other students, I would much prefer to work with you so that you can learn the material and complete the work than to see you simply withdraw or fail the course. I often recommend connecting with the office of Student Case Management (<http://www.studentcasemanagement.colostate.edu/>), as they have access to a wide variety of resources to help students in many different circumstances.

If you have other challenges that are making it difficult for you to succeed in this course, please talk with me sooner in the course than later, as we may be able to help you identify strategies or resources to help manage these (again within the bounds of fairness to all students).

Copyrighted Materials

Please do not share material from this course in online, print, or other media (including sharing links to lecture videos with individuals outside CSU). Course material is the property of the instructor who developed the course. Materials authored by third parties and used in the course are also subject to copyright protection. Posting course materials on external sites (commercial or not) violates both copyright law and the CSU Student Conduct Code. Students who share course content without the instructor's express permission, including with online sites that post materials to sell to other students, could face appropriate disciplinary or legal action.

Undocumented Student Support

Any CSU student who faces challenges or hardships due to their legal status in the United States and believes that it may impact their academic performance in this course is encouraged to visit [Student Support Services](#) for Undocumented, DACA & ASSET for resources and support. Additionally, only if you feel comfortable, please notify your professor so they may pass along any additional resources they may possess.

Food Insecurity

Any CSU student (along with faculty and staff) who is experiencing food insecurity can receive support from the [Rams Against Hunger program](#). Services include a food pantry, a meal-swipe program, pocket pantries, and in-person assistance with navigating federal aid eligibility. The RAH page includes numerous resources as well as county, state and federal programs which are described and linked.

Title IX/Interpersonal Violence

For the full statement regarding role and responsibilities about reporting harassment, sexual harassment, sexual misconduct, domestic violence, dating violence, stalking, and the retaliation policy please go to: [Title IX – Sexual Assault, Sexual Violence, Sexual Harassment](#).

If you feel that your rights have been compromised at CSU, several resources are available to assist:

Student Resolution Center, 200 Lory Student Center, 491-7165

Office of Equal Opportunity, 101 Student Services, 491-5836

A note about interpersonal violence: If you or someone you know has experienced sexual assault, relationship violence and/or stalking, know that you are not alone. As instructors, we are required by law to notify university officials about disclosures related to interpersonal violence. Confidential victim advocates are available 24 hours a day, 365 days a year to provide support related to the emotional, physical, physiological and legal aftermath of interpersonal violence. Contact the Victim Assistance Team at: 970-492-4242.

Religious Observances

CSU does not discriminate on the basis of religion. Reasonable accommodation should be made to allow individuals to observe their established religious holidays.

Please see CSU's [Religious Observances Calendar](#).

Students seeking an exemption from attending class or completing assigned course work for a religious holiday will need to fill out the [Religious Accommodation Request Form](#) and turn it in to the Division of Student Affairs, located on the second level of the Administration building. Once turned in, the Division of Student Affairs will review the request and contact the student accordingly. If approved, the student will receive a memo from the Dean of Students to give to their professor or course instructor.

Students are asked to turn in the request forms as soon as the conflict is noticed. Similarly, unanticipated conflicts requiring a religious observance, such as a death in the family, can also be reviewed.

CSU Principles of Community

Inclusion: We create and nurture inclusive environments and welcome, value and affirm all members of our community, including their various identities, skills, ideas, talents and contributions.

Integrity: We are accountable for our actions and will act ethically and honestly in all our interactions.

Respect: We honor the inherent dignity of all people within an environment where we are committed to freedom of expression, critical discourse, and the advancement of knowledge.

Service: We are responsible, individually and collectively, to give of our time, talents, and resources to promote the well-being of each other and the development of our local, regional, and global communities.

Social Justice: We have the right to be treated and the responsibility to treat others with fairness and equity, the duty to challenge prejudice, and to uphold the laws, policies and procedures that promote justice in all respects.

Student Parents/Guardians/Caregivers

CSU recognizes that student parents/guardians and caregivers face distinctive challenges in succeeding academically, and we are committed to supporting those of you who are parents to achieve course learning outcomes. If you encounter challenges in meeting course expectations – for example, fulfilling attendance and participation requirements or submitting assignments due to a child or person in your care’s illness, essential appointment, school closure, etc. – please contact your instructor as soon as possible (beforehand if feasible or as soon afterward you reasonably can if not). Work with your instructor to develop a plan for you to make up missed work. Also, please see the course syllabus for related course policies. If you need to bring your child or person you care for to class, for example because you’re nursing or planned childcare became unavailable, check with your instructor about whether you may do so if you believe it’s feasible for you to participate in class and support your child or person in your care.

Group work assignments should be designed to provide flexible approaches to participating, and all groups should develop plans that enable all members to contribute equitably. If your group encounters challenges in doing so, please reach out to your instructor to devise a solution.

Finally, know that [pregnant and parenting students are guaranteed equal educational opportunities by Title IX](#); know your rights, the protections provided, and how to advocate for yourself.

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Final Note

Please note that as the instructor, **I reserve the right to make necessary modifications to the syllabus**, including changes to the schedule, assignments, and course policies, to enhance the

learning experience and respond to unforeseen circumstances. Any updates or changes will be promptly communicated to the class **through Canvas announcement**. It is the responsibility of each student to stay informed about any syllabus revisions throughout the semester.